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Lina Khan points to Figma IPO as vindication of M&A scrutiny

A surprising figure in the Figma IPO: Lina Khan, former chair of the Federal Trade Commission.

In a Friday afternoon post-mortem, Khan wrote an article about the IPO, arguing the IPO is “a great reminder that startup groups grow up independently successful businesses, rather than being put up by existing giants, can

Khan was arguing that the lack of a “blockbuster” acquisition states over an effective

Khan was Figma’s challenge. But to the point of “reverse acquisition” and licensed outright. (The departure from

While her ego corners of the saying that c

look” and arguing that founders would ultimately benefit from “a world in which you have six or seven or eight potential suitors” rather than “just one or two.”

And although Khan — who’d been appointed by President Joe Biden — resigned at the start of the second Trump administration, her comments Friday paint the Figma IPO as a vindication for her approach, calling the IPO “a win for employees, investors, innovation, and the public.”

Of course, Khan’s critics are more likely to see Figma’s success as coming despite regulatory scrutiny, not because of

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For example, Wedbush Securities analyst Dan Ives told [Business Insider](#), "Figma is a massive success, but it's because of the company's innovative growth and not due to the FTC and [Khan]."

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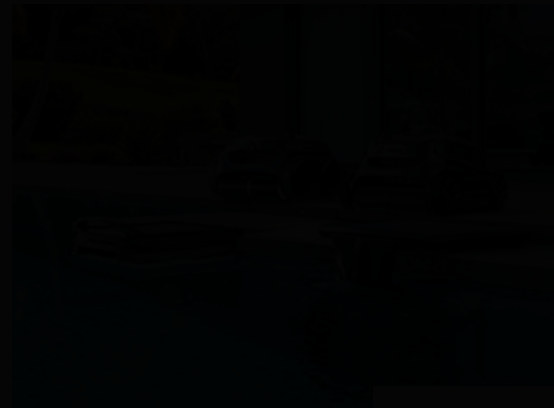


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Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

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Anthony Ha

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Anthony Ha is TechCrunch's weekend editor. Previously, he worked as a tech reporter at Adweek, a senior editor at VentureBeat, a local...

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“no mercy” and other games that depict rape, incest, and child sexual abuse.

In the following weeks, Steam announced that it would ban games that violate the rules of its “payment processors and related card networks and banks.” Then [itch.io](#) said it was removing games with adult content from its browse and search pages while conducting a broader audit.

While Mastercard’s statement seems to undermine the narrative that payment and card companies were the ones pressuring the game marketplaces, Steam owner Valve responded with a statement of its own, saying it was “not

According to Valve direct communication with banks. Payment processors and we replied attempting to

Valve said its payment processors, pointing to a damaging tr

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Meanwhile, [itch.io](#) said that it’s now re-indexing free games with adult content while negotiating with payment processors

including Stripe, which for its part said it's "unable to support sexually explicit content" due to "banking partners."

Topics: [Gaming](#) [Government & Policy](#) [Itch.io](#) [mastercard](#)

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Solarra added it was also important to demonstrate the so-
called “missionization of its platform” — how its aircraft could
be combined with the right sensors, autonomy,
communications and payload to provide a clear use case for
the DoD.

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Kirsten Korosec

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Kirsten Korosec is a reporter and editor who has covered the future of transportation from EVs and autonomous vehicles to urban air mobility.

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